

Ariel Bélair

Winnipeg, MB | Child & Youth Care Diploma (2027) — Red River College Polytechnic

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Trauma-informed Child and Youth Care practitioner with frontline residential experience supporting children ages 0–10 in a culturally grounded, 30-day emergency placement model. Skilled in early crisis recognition, emotional regulation and co-regulation, risk assessment, and collaborative team-based care. In the final year of a CYC diploma, building toward a Family Group Conferencing (FGC) Mentor role, with an arts-based practice (BFA, Dean's Honour List) that informs expressive and therapeutic programming for youth.

SKILLS

- Trauma-Informed Crisis Support
- Risk Assessment & Safety Awareness
- Professional Boundaries & Ethical Decision-Making
- Emotional Regulation & Co-Regulation
- Early Distress Recognition & De-escalation
- Collaborative Multidisciplinary Practice
- Cultural Responsiveness & Indigenous-Guided Care
- Arts-Based & Expressive Therapeutic Programming

EDUCATION

Child and Youth Care Diploma — 2027

Red River College Polytechnic

Bachelor of Fine Arts (Honours) — 2025

University of Manitoba, School of Art — Dean's Honour List

Academic focus: sociological research in child welfare systems, Indigenous history, and systemic inequities.

EXPERIENCE

Heart Helper — Ma Mawi Wi Chi Itata Centre — Circle of Care, Winnipeg, MB June 2026 – Present

- Provide nurturing, culturally grounded care for children ages 0–10 within a 30-day emergency placement model, guided by the 7 Sacred Teachings.
- Support children and sibling groups through high-complexity placements, maintaining stability and consistency of care during periods of acute need.
- Monitor behaviour and emotional states to identify early signs of escalation and intervene proactively to maintain safety and co-regulation.
- Maintain accurate, timely documentation in line with agency standards and provincial licensing requirements, contributing to case records used in placement and care planning.
- Collaborate with team members and coordinators to sustain a stable, attachment-informed environment across shift transitions.

Youth Mentor — Ma Mawi Wi Chi Itata Centre — Circle of Care, Winnipeg, MB August 2025 – June 2026

- Delivered overnight residential care for children ages 0–10 in short-term emergency placement, prioritizing safety, routine, and emotional security.
- Built rapport and trust with children navigating acute family disruption, applying trauma-informed and culturally responsive practice.
- Maintained detailed shift documentation and communicated observations across the care team to support continuity of care.

SERVICE

Weekly Studio Volunteer — Art City Inc., Winnipeg, MB

2024 – 2026

- Facilitated art-making sessions with children and youth in a community studio setting, drawing on a BFA background to design accessible creative activities.
- Built rapport with diverse participants through creative engagement, applying an early strengths-based, relational approach later formalized through CYC training.
- Supported meal preparation and cleanup in a shared community space.

Annual Volunteer — Nuit Blanche, Winnipeg, MB

2022 – 2026

- Provided information and assistance to the public during large-scale community art events.
- Supported safety and crowd flow through active monitoring and exhibit supervision.
- Represented the organization with a calm, welcoming, and professional presence in a high-traffic public setting.

Treasurer — University of Manitoba Photo Club, Winnipeg, MB

2022 – 2023

- Managed budgeting, banking, and expense tracking for a student-led club.
- Practiced accountability, transparency, and accurate record-keeping in a small-team setting.
- Collaborated with fellow executives to plan events and maintain financial stability.

Treasurer — School of Fine Arts Students Association, Winnipeg, MB

2021 – 2023

- Oversaw financial operations for a large student association, handling funds responsibly across multiple terms.
- Maintained detailed, organized financial records and served as a point of contact for financial inquiries.
- Supported peers with clarity and patience on budgeting and reimbursement processes.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

- Commit to Kids
- Circle of Security
- TCS (Therapeutic Chi Shao)
- Bringing in the Bystander®
- First Aid for Opioid Poisoning
- EFA-C & AED — Emergency First Aid with CPR Level C (Adult, Child, Infant) & AED
- Valid Class 5 Driver's License